ACM-W · NITK SURATHKAL

×

PART OF ENGINEER NITK 2K26

# recHERsion'26

## OFFICIAL HACKATHON RULEBOOK

*She imagines. She builds. She leads.*

ORGANISED BY

**ACM-W, NITK Surathkal**

as part of Engineer NITK 2K26

| 24–25 OCT | 36 HOURS | 100% ONLINE |
|---|---|---|
| 2026 | 9 AM Sat – 9 PM Sun | Women-only hackathon |

# 1. About recHERsion 2026

recHERsion 2026 is the flagship women-only hackathon organised by ACM-W, NITK Surathkal, as part of Engineer NITK 2K26. The event provides a platform for women students to collaborate, apply their technical skills, and develop practical technology-driven solutions to real-world challenges.

# 2. Event Details

| Event | recHERsion 2026 \| Women-Only Hackathon |
|---|---|
| **Organiser** | ACM-W, NITK Surathkal |
| **Fest** | Engineer NITK 2K26 |
| **Dates** | 24–25 October 2026 |
| **Schedule** | Saturday, 24 October, 9:00 AM IST to Sunday, 25 October, 9:00 PM IST |
| **Mode** | Completely online |
| **Total duration** | 36 hours |
| **Problem statements** | Two; each team must choose one |
| **Team size** | 2–3 members |
| **Inter-college teams** | Allowed |
| **Prize pool** | ₹50,000 total; ₹15,000 for the Winner and ₹10,000 for the Runner-up of each problem statement |
| **Results** | To be declared by Thursday/Friday {29-30 October 2026} at the latest |

# 3. Eligibility and Team Formation

- The hackathon is open exclusively to women students enrolled in colleges or universities.
- Each team must consist of 2–3 members.
- Inter-college teams are permitted.
- Each participant may be part of only one team.
- Teams should designate one team leader as the primary contact for organiser communications and submissions.
- Teams must provide accurate team-member and registration details when requested.

# 4. Hackathon Structure and Timeline

## Phase 1: Problem Statement Selection — 6 Hours

Saturday, 24 October 2026 | 9:00 AM–3:00 PM IST

Two problem statements will be released at the beginning of the hackathon. Teams must review both and select one problem statement to work on.

- Teams must submit the designated form with their team name, selected problem statement, and required team details within the six-hour window.
- Problem statement selection cannot be changed after the six-hour window closes.

## Phase 2: Prototype Development — 30 Hours

Saturday, 24 October 2026, 3:00 PM–Sunday, 25 October 2026, 9:00 PM IST

Teams will develop a functional prototype based on the problem statement confirmed in Phase 1. All project development must be completed within this 30-hour window.

- Teams should focus on implementing core functionality and producing a demonstrable prototype.
- Teams may use suitable programming languages, frameworks, APIs, libraries, development tools, and publicly available resources, subject to applicable licences and terms.
- Teams must be able to explain their solution, implementation, and use of third-party resources.

## 5. Final Submission Requirements

Each team must submit all required deliverables by Sunday, 25 October 2026, at 9:00 PM IST. The final submission must be completed by the same deadline as prototype development; no additional upload-only window is provided.

- GitHub Repository: A link to the project repository containing the source code and implementation.
- Project Presentation (PPT): A presentation describing the problem, proposed solution, key features, technical approach, and potential impact.
- Demo Video: A video demonstrating the prototype and its core functionality.

## 6. Development Cut-off and Repository Rules

- The prototype development and final submission deadline is Sunday, 25 October 2026, at 9:00 PM IST.
- Any Git commit made to the submitted project repository after the prototyping deadline will result in disqualification.
- Teams should ensure that the submitted repository and its commit history are accessible for verification.
- Teams should not push code changes after the prototyping deadline, including minor fixes.
- The organisers may review commit history to verify compliance with the development cut-off.
- All required deliverables (GitHub repository, project presentation, and demo video) must be submitted by 9:00 PM IST. Teams should not rely on any post-deadline submission window.

## 7. Evaluation Criteria

Projects will be evaluated by the judging panel based on the following criteria, for a total of 100 marks:

| Criterion | Weight | What judges may consider |
|---|---|---|
| **Problem Relevance & Understanding** | 15% | Clarity of understanding of the problem statement, identification of target users, and effectiveness in addressing the problem. |
| **Innovation & Originality** | 15% | Creativity, uniqueness of the approach, differentiation from existing solutions, and thoughtful use of technology. |
| **Technical Implementation** | 20% | Code quality, technical depth, architecture, integration, and appropriate use of technologies. |
| **Working MVP & Demonstration** | 25% | Functionality and completeness of the prototype, successful demonstration of core features, and validation of the solution through an end-to-end workflow. |
| **Feasibility & Potential Impact** | 15% | Practical applicability, feasibility of implementation, scalability, and potential real-world impact. |
| **User Experience & Accessibility** | 10% | Ease of use, intuitive design, accessibility, and overall user experience. |

### Working MVP & Demonstration — Detailed Breakdown

The 25 marks allocated to this criterion will be assessed as follows:

| Component | Weight | What is assessed |
|---|---|---|
| **Core Functionality** | 10% | How well the implemented features work as intended. |
| **End-to-End Workflow** | 5% | Whether the solution demonstrates a complete and coherent workflow. |
| **Prototype Completeness & Integration** | 5% | Completeness of the prototype and integration of its components. |
| **Demonstration & Validation** | 5% | How effectively the demo demonstrates and validates the solution using a relevant scenario. |

### Important Evaluation Notes

- Judging will focus on the actual implementation and demonstrated capabilities of the submitted project.
- Features that are only proposed, described, or presented as static mock-ups will not receive full functionality marks.
- Teams are encouraged to demonstrate a functional, coherent MVP rather than an extensive set of incomplete features in the demo video.
- Technical complexity alone does not guarantee a higher score; the implementation must be relevant to the problem statement.
- The same evaluation criteria will apply to both problem statements.

## 8. Prizes and Recognition

The total prize pool is ₹50,000. One Winner and one Runner-up will be recognised for each of the two problem statements. The Winner of each problem statement will receive ₹15,000, and the Runner-up of each problem statement will receive ₹10,000.

## 9. Code of Conduct and Originality

- All submitted work must represent the team's own effort during the hackathon. Plagiarism, unauthorised copying, impersonation, or misrepresentation of contributions is prohibited.
- Previously developed projects must not be presented as newly built hackathon work without substantial development during the event.
- Third-party code, libraries, APIs, datasets, models, and assets may be used where permitted by their applicable licences and terms. Relevant sources and assets must be acknowledged.
- Teams must respect other participants and organisers and maintain professional conduct throughout the event.
- Participants must comply with applicable laws, platform policies, and ethical standards.

## 10. Disqualification

A team may be disqualified for:

- Making a Git commit to the submitted project repository after the prototyping deadline.
- Changing the selected problem statement after the six-hour selection window closes.
- Submitting plagiarised work or misrepresenting project ownership or contributions.
- Providing false registration or team information.
- Violating event rules or engaging in misconduct that compromises the fairness of the hackathon.

## 11. Communication and Organiser Decisions

- Participants should monitor the official Unstop listing and organiser communication channels for updates, links, deadlines, and submission instructions.
- Any changes to the schedule or event procedures will be communicated through official channels.
- The organisers reserve the right to interpret and enforce these rules and to disqualify teams that violate them.
- The judging panel's decisions regarding rankings and awards will be final.

## 12. Quick Reference

| **Hackathon start** | **Saturday, 24 October 2026, 9:00 AM IST** |
|---|---|
| **Problem selection closes** | Saturday, 24 October 2026, 3:00 PM IST |
| **Prototype development closes** | Sunday, 25 October 2026, 9:00 PM IST |
| **Final deliverables** | GitHub repository, PPT, and demo video |
| **Problem statement changes** | Not permitted after the first six hours |
| **Post-deadline commits** | Result in disqualification |
| **Awards** | Winner: ₹15,000 and Runner-up: ₹10,000 for each problem statement |
| **Results Announcements** | By 29-30 October 2026 |

***She imagines. She builds. She leads.***